Council with the EU is an indicator of the direction in which the winds are blowing. There has been even more marked progress with the US on this front, as indeed with the other two Quad partners.

A different dimension is the contribution we can make to the stability and security of the global commons, especially in the Indo-Pacific. At the same time, India is a partner of value in forums like BRICS and the Shanghai Cooperation Organization (SCO). Our independent stance always leaves open participation in any endeavour at conflict mitigation or resolution. The combination of Covid support, digital delivery and development projects has also created a deeper constituency in the Global South. It is not lost on the developing world that we commenced our G20 presidency with the Voice of the Global South Summit. Nor, for that matter, that we championed the membership of the AU in the G20.

The last decade has also established convincingly that Indian development initiatives are truly demand-driven and do not conceal a hidden agenda. Certainly, India's ability to straddle the big fissures that global politics is currently grappling with is part of its overall standing in the world.

DECODING MODI-ERA DIPLOMACY

We have till now focussed on how India has dealt with the world differently and the extent to which this, in turn, has shaped global views about India. Our appreciation, however, would be incomplete if we do not give adequate attention to the change in the very understanding of what foreign policy is all about. It may look as a shift in emphasis but is very much more than that.

Foreign policy is now seen as a direct instrument to accelerate national development and modernization. The flow of technology, capital and best practices are the ensuing focal points. Wooing the world is expressed in encouraging investors, especially by making it easier to do business. Interactions with them are as frequent as those with technology-providers and high achievers in different domains. AatmaNirbhar Bharat Abhiyan and Make in India provide an overall framework that facilitate such exercises, supported by initiatives like Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) on manufacturing or Gati Shakti in infrastructure.